

Rolling out pastry



Good quality shop-bought pastry is a great time-saver. All you need to do is roll it out.

- 1 Sprinkle flour onto a rolling pin and your work surface. Use the rolling pin to push down and forward over the pastry, using long, steady strokes.
- 2 Turn the pastry around and repeat as necessary, until it reaches your desired thickness.

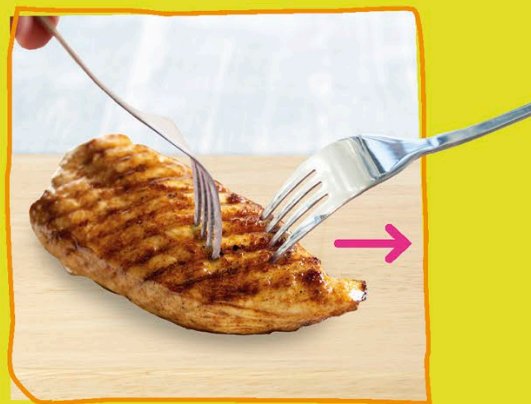
Separating eggs



Some recipes only require the egg white or yolk. Luckily, it's easy to separate them.

- 1 Crack an egg on the side of a bowl. Transfer the yolk back and forth from one half of the shell to the other, letting the white fall into the bowl and holding the yolk in the shell.

Shredding chicken



Shredded, leftover chicken can be used in lots of other dishes. It's a great way to get the most out of your ingredients.

- 1 Wait for the cooked chicken to cool thoroughly and use one fork to hold it still and another to pull it apart. Alternatively, slice the breasts off the carcass and pulse them in a food processor.

Dicing onions



Onions are used in lots of recipes, so learning how to dice one is a skill worth knowing.

- 1 Peel the onion and slice it in half from root to stem.
- 2 Make several vertical slices toward the root, being careful not to cut all the way to the end.
- 3 Repeat with horizontal cuts, then hold the onion together and slice down across the cuts you made earlier.

Lining a cake tin



Lining a tin will stop your cake from sticking to it, making it easier to remove.

- 1 Grease the tin by spreading a layer of oil or butter onto the base and sides.
- 2 Place the tin on baking paper and draw around the edges, leaving a little extra on all sides.
- 3 Cut the paper out and press it into the tin. Fold at the corners and snip off any excess.

Kneading dough



Kneading dough can be quite a physical job, but at least it will make you strong!

- 1 Place the dough onto a floured surface. Using clean hands, stretch the dough by pushing it down and away from you with the heel of your hands.
- 2 Fold the dough back toward you. Rotate and repeat for 5-10 minutes until the dough has become smooth and elastic.